

Employee Handbook

Company: Northwind Analytics Inc.

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

1. About Northwind Analytics

Northwind Analytics Inc. was founded in 2016 and is headquartered in Austin, Texas, with a satellite office in Toronto, Canada. The company has approximately 340 employees as of 2026.

2. Working Hours

Standard working hours are 9:00 AM to 5:30 PM local time, Monday through Friday, with a 30-minute unpaid lunch break. Core collaboration hours, during which all employees must be reachable, are 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM.

3. Remote Work Policy

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week. Fully remote arrangements require written approval from a Director-level manager or above. Employees must be available on video for all scheduled meetings regardless of location.

4. Paid Time Off

Full-time employees accrue 18 days of paid vacation per year during their first three years of employment, increasing to 23 days after three years of tenure. Employees also receive 8 paid sick days per year and 11 paid company holidays.

5. Probation Period

All new hires undergo a 90-day probationary period, during which either party may terminate employment with 2 weeks' notice.

6. Benefits

Northwind offers a 401(k) retirement plan with a 4 percent company match on employee contributions up to 6 percent of salary. Health insurance premiums are covered at 85 percent by the company for employees and 60 percent for dependents. Employees become eligible for benefits on the first day of the month following their start date.

7. Expense Policy

Employees may expense up to \$75 per day for meals while traveling on company business, and must submit receipts for any single expense over \$25. Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of the expense being incurred.

8. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, and partners with respect and professionalism. Harassment, discrimination, and retaliation of any kind are strictly prohibited and should be reported to Human Resources or via the anonymous ethics hotline.

9. Performance Reviews

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice per year, in June and December. New hires receive an additional 90-day review during their probation period.